Where the Papers Are

The deed, statements, policies and beneficiary forms behind Dad's list, on one page.

The deed is in the safe-deposit box, or it was. The beneficiary forms were filled in when Dad opened the accounts, and they've sat in a file ever since.

This page doesn't ask you to read or understand any of them. It asks where each paper is, what date is on it, who holds it, and which ones nobody has seen.

WHAT TO FIND	WHERE IT IS	ITS DATE	WHO HOLDS IT
The deed to Dad's home			
Deeds to any other real estate			
A recent statement for each bank account			
A recent statement for each investment account			
A recent statement for each retirement account			
Insurance policies, with the latest statement for each			
Annuity contracts, with the latest statement for each			
Beneficiary forms for the retirement accounts, insurance and annuities			
Trust papers, if Dad has a trust			
Papers for anything owned jointly with someone else			
Vehicle titles, and papers for any business interest			
The family's list of what Dad owns			

What nobody has seen, and who will look for it

Anything above with an empty line. Put a name next to each. There's no hurry; a paper nobody has seen is one line on this list.

FOR EXAMPLE Nobody has seen the beneficiary form for the retirement account. Dad will ask the company for a copy of what's on file.

How to use it

- Write the date printed on each paper. If it has no date, write “undated.”
- Don't copy account numbers or summarize a document here. Just say where it is.
- When something changes, such as an account opened or closed or a beneficiary form updated, change the row and its date.
- Bring this page with you when you talk with your Medicaid planner or an elder law attorney.

What this page doesn't do

It doesn't explain what any deed, statement, policy or form means, or how anything on it would be treated. If you read something you don't understand, that's a question for the company that issued it, for your Medicaid planner or for an elder law attorney. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You know where each paper is, how recent it is and which ones nobody has seen. The planning interview uses what you've found: it asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care.

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